WHAT IS HIP-HOP

STUDIO

DANCE CORE

BY JAYARUWAN PRABODYA

HIP - HOP

Hip hop is a cultural movement and art form that originated in the Bronx, New York City, during the 1970s, primarily among African American, Afro-Caribbean, and Latino youth. It includes a wide range of artistic expressions, but it is commonly known for four main elements:

01. MCing(Rapping)

This is the vocal element—rhythmic spoken delivery of lyrics, often with rhyme, wordplay, and storytelling.

02. DJing (Turntablism)

This involves mixing music on turntables, manipulating records to create beats, loops, and scratching effects.

03. Breakdancing (B-boying/B-girling)

A dynamic dance style that features acrobatic moves, spins, footwork, and freezes. It originated on the streets and is deeply tied to the rhythm of hip hop music.

04. Graffiti Art

Visual art using spray paint, often done on public surfaces. It serves as a form of self-expression and rebellion, and is considered the visual language of hip hop.

Additional Elements (Recognized over time):

- Beatboxing – Vocal percussion using the mouth.
- Hip hop fashion – Baggy clothes, sneakers, caps, gold chains, etc.
- Hip hop slang – A unique lexicon that evolves with the culture.
- Knowledge – Awareness of social, political, and community issues, which was emphasized especially in conscious hip hop.

Musical Style:

Hip hop music is usually built around beats, often sampled or created electronically, with rhythmic and lyrical flows from rappers. Themes can range from party vibes and braggadocio to deep political commentary and personal storytelling.

Popular Artists (classic & modern):

- Old School: Grandmaster Flash, Run-DMC, Tupac, The Notorious B.I.G., Public Enemy
- Modern: Kendrick Lamar, J. Cole, Drake, Travis Scott, Nicki Minaj

Origin of Hip Hop Dance

Hip hop dance originated in the early 1970s in the South Bronx, New York City, as a core element of hip hop culture. It was created by Black, Latino, and Afro-Caribbean youth who used dance as a form of expression, identity, and resistance.

Key Origins

Hip hop music is usually built around beats, often sampled or created electronically, with rhythmic and lyrical flows from rappers. Themes can range from party vibes and braggadocio to deep political commentary and personal storytelling.

1. Breaking (Breakdancing) – The First Hip Hop Dance

- Where: South Bronx block parties.
- When: Early 1970s.
- Pioneers: DJs like Kool Herc extended the drum breaks in funk/disco songs so dancers (called B-boys and B-girls) could "break" into creative moves.
- Influences: Martial arts, gymnastics, African dance, and funk styles.

2. Funk Styles (Popping & Locking)

- Where: West Coast (mainly Los Angeles).
- When: Mid-1970s.
- Pioneers:

  Popping: Created by Boogaloo Sam.

  Locking: Created by Don Campbell.

- Though not originally called "hip hop," they were absorbed into hip hop dance culture later, especially through shows like Soul Train.

3. Street & Club Culture

- Dancers would freestyle at house parties, clubs, and on the streets.
- Battles (dance competitions) became popular ways to showcase skill and earn respect.
- The dance was raw, expressive, and constantly evolving with the music.

Why It Grew:

- Hip hop dance gave young people a voice without words.
- It was a way to cope with poverty, crime, and systemic oppression.
- Dance crews formed as positive alternatives to gangs.

Media Boost (1980s–90s):

- Films like Beat Street, Wild Style, and Breakin' introduced hip hop dance to the world.
- Shows like Soul Train and Yo! MTV Raps helped spread the culture.
- Hip hop dance became global while still evolving locally.

Today:

Hip hop dance has evolved into many styles, including krumping, house, litefeet, and viral TikTok-style routines—but its roots remain in freedom, rhythm, and community.

ORIGIN OF HIP HOP DANCE

EARLY 1970s

BREAKING (BREAKDANCING)

- Emerges in the South Bronx
- Inspired by funk music breaks
- Combines acrobatic and rhythmic moves

MID-1970s

FUNK STYLES (POPPING & LOCKING)

- Developed on the West Coast
- Popularized through TV shows like *Soul Train*

1980s–1990s

MEDIA EXPOSURE

- Films showcase hip hop culture
- Dance becomes known worldwide

PRESENT

EVOLUTION

- New styles such as krumping
- Viral dance trends
- Global influence

Main Hip Hop Dance Styles

1. Breaking (Breakdancing)

- The original hip hop dance style.
- Includes toprock (standing moves), downrock (floor work), power moves (spins, flips), and freezes (poses).
- Athletic and acrobatic.

2. Popping

- Quick muscle contractions to create a jerking effect.
- Often paired with robotic and isolated movements.

3. Locking

- Characterized by sudden pauses ("locks") in the middle of fast movements.
- Playful, exaggerated, and often uses large arm and hand gestures.

4. Krumping

- High-energy, aggressive, and expressive.
- Created as a way to release anger and frustration in a positive way.

5. House Dance

- Originated in house music clubs, but often considered part of hip hop dance.
- Focuses on fast footwork, fluid movement, and grooving.

6. Litefeet & New School Styles

- Newer dance trends from cities like New York.
- Often go viral on social media (e.g., dances popular on TikTok or YouTube).

More Than Just Movement:

Hip hop dancing is not just about moves—it's about self-expression, attitude, and community. It tells stories, reflects personal style, and often addresses deeper themes like identity, resilience, and social issues.

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